

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 871

By Martin B

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Dorris Parkins of Milan.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Dorris Parkins of Milan; and

WHEREAS, Dorris Parkins was an exemplary individual and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on April 5, 1932, Dorris Parkins was the daughter of Denton William Fly and Esther Lee Rollins Fly and grew up working on her family farm while attending schools in Milan; and

WHEREAS, at the age of seventeen, she was stricken with polio, which ended her promising basketball career. With the aid of crutches, she graduated with her classmates, attended college, and walked down the aisle with the love of her life, Bob Parkins; and

WHEREAS, the Parkinses' joyous marriage was blessed with the birth of eight healthy children; and

WHEREAS, in 1965, Bob and Dorris Parkins founded the *Milan Mirror* newspaper; they also owned and operated Green Acres Farm, which included over 300 dairy cows and a tomato packing shed that employed hundreds and supplied some of the largest tomato producers in the world; and

WHEREAS, an artist at heart, Dorris Parkins loved ceramics and porcelain so much that she opened her own business, Dorris' Ceramics, in 1970; she held many classes there and shared her passion for art with countless individuals from all over the region; and

WHEREAS, an active part of her community, Mrs. Parkins shared her time and talents with the PTA, Freed-Hardeman College Associates, Graball Community Center, 4-H, and the

YMCA, and she was recognized as a fifty-year member of the Daughters of the American Revolution; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Dorris Parkins was named the Milan Woman of the Year in 1982 by the Milan Chamber, the Woman of the Year by the Milan Garden Club in 1971, and Mother of the Year by the Milan VFW in 1971 and was noted in *Outstanding Women in America*; and

WHEREAS, perhaps her most prestigious recognition came in 1968, when Governor Buford Ellington presented her with the coveted Governor's Trophy as Tennessee's Handicapped Citizen of the Year; and

WHEREAS, the epitome of the Milan Community who has left a lasting legacy of grace that will live on forever, Dorris Parkins was deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, a beloved family matriarch, Dorris Parkins is survived by her eight devoted children, twelve cherished grandchildren, and a host of treasured great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, she was preceded in death by her husband of fifty-six years, Bob Parkins, and her parents, Denton and Esther Fly; and

WHEREAS, Dorris Parkins leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional individual and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Dorris Parkins, reflecting fondly upon her

impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Parkins.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.